

American decline

American decline is the idea that the United States of America is diminishing in power geopolitically, militarily, financially, economically, socially, culturally, in matters of healthcare, and/or on environmental issues.^{[1][2][3]} There has been debate over the extent of the decline, and whether it is relative or absolute. Those who believe America is in decline are declinists.^{[4][5]}

China challenging the United States for global dominance constitutes a core issue in the debate over American decline.^{[6][7][8]} The United States is no longer the only uncontested superpower to dominate in every domain in every region of the world.^{[9][10]} According to the 2021 Asia Power Index, within Asia, the United States still takes the lead on *military capacity*, *cultural influence*, *resilience*, *future resources*, *diplomatic influence*, and *defense networks*, but falls behind China in two parameters: *economic capability* and *economic relationships*.^[11]

Shrinking military advantages, deficit spending, geopolitical overreach, and a shift in moral, social, and behavioral conditions have been associated with American decline.

Some scholars say that the perception of decline, or declinism, has long been part of American culture.^{[12][13]} In a 2021 poll of 1,019 Americans just after the riot at the Capitol, 79% of those surveyed said that America is "falling apart". At the same time, a similar proportion of survey respondents indicated that they are "proud to be an American".^{[14][15][16][17]}

Contents

Assessment

- Military

 - Deficit spending

 - Geopolitical overreach

- Culture

- Political polarization

- Economy

- Health

Competition with China

- Factors and debates

- Foreign policy

Comparison with earlier states

- Roman empire

- Britain

- Soviet Union

Commentators

Public opinion

See also

References

Further reading

Assessment

According to American public intellectual Noam Chomsky, America's decline started shortly after the end of World War II, with the "loss of China" followed by the Indochina Wars. By 1970, the United States' share of world wealth had declined to about 25%, which was still large but sharply reduced.^[18] Chomsky dismisses the "remarkable rhetoric of the several years of triumphalism in the 1990s" as "mostly self-delusion". However, Chomsky argued in 2011 that power will not shift to China and India, because these are poor countries with severe internal problems, and there will be no competitor for global hegemonic power in the foreseeable future.^[18]

According to Jeet Heer, U.S. hegemony has always been supported by three pillars: "economic strength, military might, and the soft power of cultural dominance."^[19] According to American diplomat Eric S. Edelman, the declinists, or those who believe America is in decline, have been "consistently wrong" in the past.^[5] However, American political scientist Aaron Friedberg cautioned that just because the declinists were wrong in the past does not mean they will be incorrect in their future predictions, and that some of the arguments by the declinists deserve to be taken seriously.^{[5][20]}

Political scientist Matthew Kroenig argues Washington has "followed the same basic, three-step geopolitical plan since 1945. First, the United States built the current, rules-based international system... Second, it welcomed into the club any country that played by the rules, even former adversaries... and third, the U.S. worked with its allies to defend the system from those countries or groups that would challenge it."^[21]

Military

According to a 98-page report by National Defense Strategy Commission, "America's longstanding military advantages have diminished", and "The country's strategic margin for error has become distressingly small. Doubts about America's ability to deter and, if necessary, defeat opponents and honor its global commitments have proliferated." The report cited "political dysfunction" and "budget caps" as factors restraining the government from keeping pace with threats in what the report described as "a crisis of national security." The report wrote that, to neutralize American strength, China and Russia were trying to achieve "regional hegemony" and were developing "aggressive military buildups".^[22] In 2018, Air Force General Frank Gorenc said that the United States airpower advantage over Russia and China was shrinking.^[23] According to Loren Thompson, the military's decline began when defense secretary Dick Cheney stopped a hundred major weapons programs 25 years ago when the Soviet Union collapsed.^[24]

Deficit spending

Paul Kennedy posits that continued deficit spending, especially on military build-up, is the single most important reason for decline of any great power. The costs of the wars in Iraq and Afghanistan are now estimated to run as high as \$4.4 trillion, which Kennedy deems a major victory for Osama bin Laden, whose announced goal was to humiliate America by showcasing its casualty averseness and lack of will to persist in a long term conflict. By 2011, the U.S. military budget — almost matching that of the rest of the world combined — was higher in real terms than at any time since WWII.^[25]

Kennedy made similar assessments about American decline in his book *The Rise and Fall of the Great Powers* in which he projected “a need to ‘manage’ affairs so that the relative erosion of the United States' position takes place slowly and smoothly”.^[26] The book was published in 1989, three years before the dissolution of the Soviet Union and several years before the bursting of the Japanese asset price bubble, leaving the United States as the sole remaining superpower and the dominant political and economic power internationally.^[27]

Geopolitical overreach

According to historian Emmanuel Todd, an expansion in military activity and aggression can appear to be an increase in power, but can mask a decline in power. He observes that this occurred with the Soviet Union in the 1970s, and with the Roman Empire,^[28] and that the United States may be going through a similar period in time.

There were 38 large and medium-sized American facilities spread around the globe in 2005—mostly air and naval bases—approximately the same number as Britain's 36 naval bases and army garrisons at its imperial zenith in 1898.^[29] Yale historian Paul Kennedy compares the U.S. situation to Great Britain's prior to World War I, saying that the map of U.S. bases is similar.^[25]



Countries with United States military bases and facilities in 2016

Culture

Commentators such as Allan Bloom, E. D. Hirsch and Russel Jacoby have suggested American culture is in decline.^[30] Samuel P. Huntington commented critically on a trend in American culture and politics of predicting constant decline since the late 1950s. As he saw it, declinism came in several distinct waves, namely in reaction to the Soviet Union's launch of Sputnik; to the Vietnam War; to the oil shock of 1973; to Soviet tensions in the late 1970s; and to the general unease that accompanied the end of the Cold War.^[4] According to American historian Russell Jacoby, the rise of academic Marxism, radical political economies, and critical literary and cultural studies since the World War II has contributed to the decline of American culture.^[30]

William J. Bennett argues that America's cultural decline is signaling "a shift in the public's attitudes and beliefs".^[31] According to the Index of Leading Cultural Indicators, published in 1993, statistically portraying the moral, social and behavioral conditions of modern American society, often described as 'values', America's cultural condition was in decline with respect to the situations of 30 years ago, 1963. The index showed that there has been an increase in violent crime by more than 6 times, illegitimate births by more than 5 times, the divorce rate by 5 times, the percentage of children living in single-parent homes by four times, and the teenage suicide rate by three times during the 30-year period.^[31]

According to Kenneth Weisbrode, though some statistics point to American decline (increased death rate, political paralysis, and increased crime), "Americans have had a low culture for a very long time, and have long promoted it". He thinks that the obsession with decline is not something new, as something dating back to the Puritans. "Cultural decline, in other words, is as American as apple pie," Weisbrode argues. Weisbrode likens pre-revolutionary France and present-day America for their vulgarity, which he argues is "an almost natural extension or outcome of all that is civilized: a glorification of ego."^[12]

Daniel Bell argued that the perception of decline is part of the culture. "What the long history of American 'declinism' -- as opposed to America's actual possible decline -- suggests," says Daniel Bell, "is that these anxieties have an existence of their own that is quite distinct from the actual geopolitical position of our country; that they arise as much from something deeply rooted in the collective psyche of our chattering classes as from sober political and economic analyses."^[13]

According to RealClearPolitics, declarations of America's declining power have been common since the beginning of the country.^[32] According to Australian journalist Nick Bryant, "warnings of American decline are by no means new".^[33] In the 20th century, declinism came in several distinct waves.^{[34][35]} In a 2011 book, Thomas L. Friedman and Michael Mandelbaum argued that the United States was in the midst of "its fifth wave of Declinism." The first had come "with the 'Sputnik Shock' of 1957," the second with the Vietnam War, the third with President Jimmy Carter's "malaise" and the rise of Japan, the fourth with the increased power of China.^[36] According to Robert Lieber in 2021, "declinists' proclamations about America have appeared ever since America's founding" and "it can be instructive to compare current arguments and prescriptions of the new declinism with the ideas of earlier eras."^[35]

Political polarization

Many commentators and polls have observed an increase in political polarization in the US.^[37]

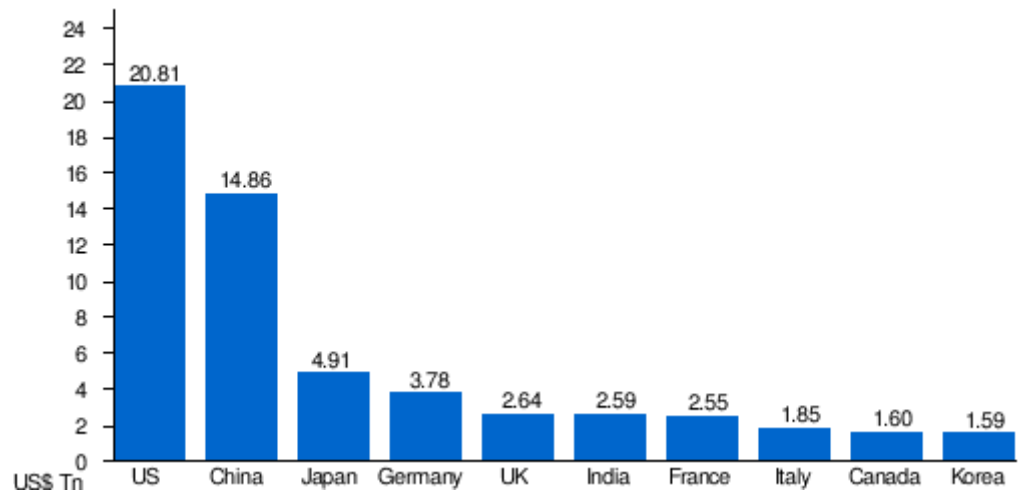
Some researchers have linked trends towards political polarization in the United States and other countries to increased economic inequality and economic decline.^{[38][39]} David Leonhardt writes that "incomes, wealth and life expectancy in the United States have stagnated for much of the population, contributing to an angry national mood and exacerbating political divisions. The result is a semidysfunctional government that is eroding many of the country's largest advantages over China."^[40]

According to a report by Oxford researchers including sociologist Philip N. Howard, social media played a major role in political polarization in the United States, due to computational propaganda -- "the use of automation, algorithms, and big-data analytics to manipulate public life"—such as the spread of fake news and conspiracy theories. The researchers highlighted the role of the Russian Internet Research Agency in attempts to undermine democracy in the US and exacerbate existing political divisions. The most prominent methods of misinformation were ostensibly organic posts rather than ads, and influence operation activity increased after, and was not limited to, the 2016 election.^{[41][42]} Sarah Kreps of Brookings points out that in the wake of foreign influence operations which are nothing new but boosted by digital tools, the U.S. has had to spend exorbitantly on defensive measures "just to break even on democratic legitimacy."^[43]

Michael McFaul, former U.S. Ambassador to Russia from 2012 to 2014, believes the U.S. has faced a democratic decline, stemming from elite polarization and damage done by former President Donald Trump to trust in elections and bonds with democratic allies. McFaul states that the decline in democracy weakens national security and heavily restrains foreign policy.^[44]

According to 2021 survey data compiled from YouGov, Nationscape, and the Voter Study Group, 36% of Republican and 33% of Democrat respondents say that they "feel justified to use violence to advance political goals". This represents a sharp increase from 2017, in which only 8% of Republican and 8% of Democrat respondents said the same.^[45] Similarly, a survey performed by the University of Virginia Center for Politics found that more than 80% of both Democrats and Republicans believe that the opposing party poses "a clear and present danger to American democracy". Overall, more than 80% of survey respondents said they are afraid that they or someone close to them will experience "personal loss or suffering due to the effects" of the opposing party's policies.^[46]

Economy



Largest economies by nominal GDP in 2020^[47]

By 1970 U.S. share of world production had fallen from 40% to 25%,^[18] while economist Jeffrey Sachs observed the US share of world income was 24.6% in 1980 falling to 19.1% in 2011.^[19] The ratio of average CEO earnings to average workers' pay in the U.S. went from 24:1 in 1965 to 262:1 in 2005.^{[48][1]} In 2018, income inequality reached the highest level recorded by the Census Bureau.^[49]

Some centrists believe that the American fiscal crisis stems from the rising expenditures on social programs or alternatively from the increases in military spending for the Iraq and Afghanistan wars, both of which would lead to decline. However, Richard Lachmann argues that if military or overall spending is not pressuring the U.S. economy, they would not contribute to U.S. decline. Lachmann describes the real problem as "the misallocation of government revenue and expenditure, resulting in resources being diverted from the tasks vital to maintain economic or geopolitical dominance."^[50] Kennedy argues that as military expenses grow, this reduces investments in economic growth, which eventually "leads to the downward spiral of slower growth, heavier taxes, deepening domestic splits over spending priorities, and weakening capacity to bear the burdens of defense."^[25]

Health

Various analysts have connected health challenges in the United States, such as rising healthcare costs, to overall national decline. A 2018 paper in the American Journal of Public Health reviewed multiple factors that were observed by previous researchers such as rising health care costs, decreased life expectancy, and an increase in "deaths of despair" such as suicides and drug overdoses, and connected this to "the long-term malaise seen in the United States".^[51] The rate of maternal mortality has more than doubled in the U.S. since the late 1980s in stark contrast to other developed nations.^[52] The economists Anne Case and Angus Deaton attribute this rising mortality, which is mostly impacting the working class, to the flaws in contemporary capitalism.^[53]

According to the Social Progress Index, the US is facing "small but steady declines" in health and other matters and along with Brazil and Hungary was one of few nations to slide backwards on the index between 2010 and 2020. Concerning the index, Nicholas Kristof said this points to structural problems that predate Trump, Trump being "a symptom of this malaise, and also a cause of its acceleration".^[54]

Many scientific experts and former government officials have criticized Donald Trump and his administration's role in the COVID-19 pandemic response, such as interfering with science agencies and perpetrating falsehoods during the COVID-19 pandemic.^{[55][56][57]} In *Nature*, Jeff Tollefson warned that

Trump's damage to science could take decades to recover from, and some of this damage could be permanent.^[55] In October 2020, Pew Research found that Trump's handling of the coronavirus pandemic eroded America's already declining global reputation.^{[58][59]}

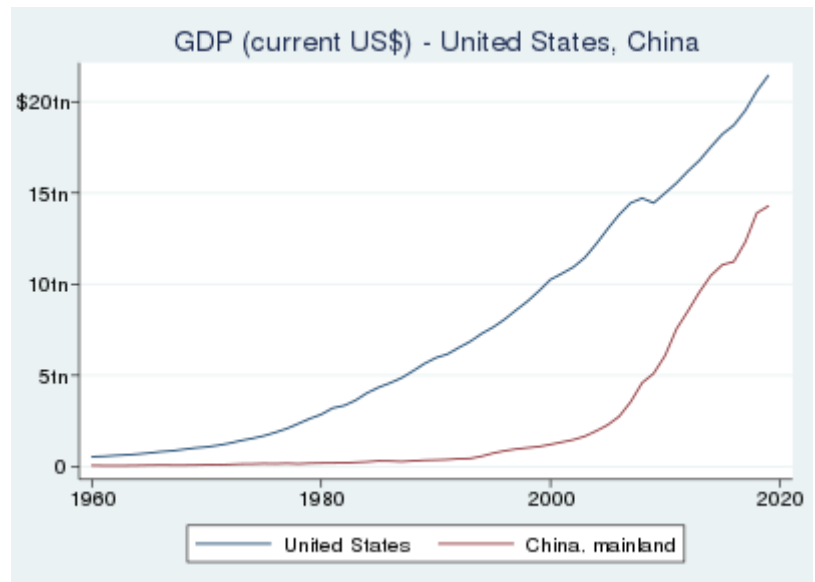
Competition with China

Factors and debates

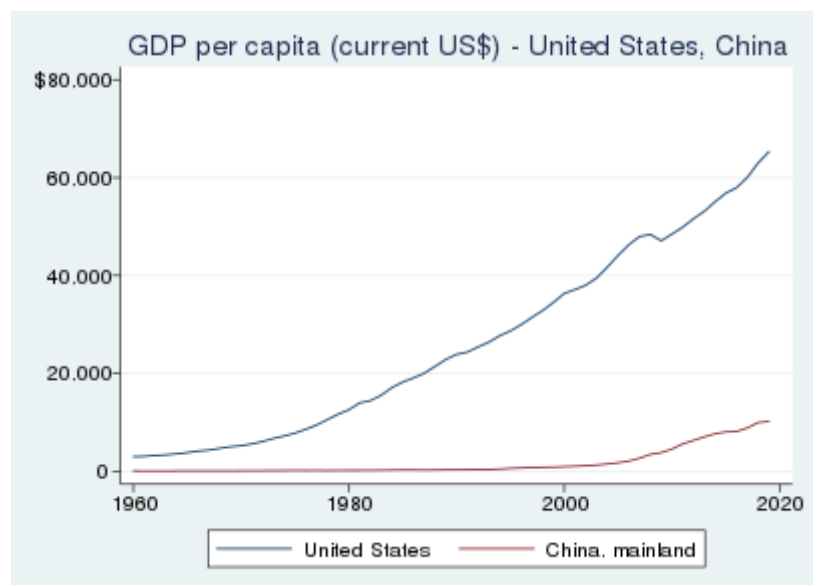
China challenging the United States for global dominance constitutes a core issue in the debate over the American decline.^{[6][7][8]} The United States is no longer the only uncontested superpower to dominate in every domain (i.e. military, culture, economy, technology, diplomatic) in every region of the world.^{[9][10]} According to the 2021 Asia Power Index, within Asia, the United States still takes the lead on *military capacity, cultural influence, resilience, future resources, diplomatic influence, and defense networks*, but falls behind China in two parameters: *economic capability* and *economic relationships*.^[11]

In 2020, China signed the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership, the world's largest free trade bloc.^[60] Time magazine argued the US could be "the big loser" of the deal.^[61] However, The Wall Street Journal reported that the tariff-related liberalizations from RCEP would be modest, calling it a "paper tiger". A comprehensive study into the deal shows that it would add just 0.08% to China's 2030 GDP without India's participation.^{[62][63]}

China also surpassed the US in trade with the European Union for the first time in 2020.^[64] In December, the EU announced the Comprehensive Agreement on Investment with China was concluded in principle.^[65] Some analysts said the agreement may damage relations with the US.^[66] In March 2021, it was reported that there would be serious doubts about the approval of the deal in the European Parliament given China's "unacceptable" behavior toward members of the parliament, the European Council's Political and Security Committee, and European think tanks.^{[67][68]}



GDP (current US\$) - United States, China (in trillions of US\$, 1960–2019)



GDP per capita - United States, China (1960–2019)

In 2020, China surpassed the US for a second time as the world's leading nation for foreign direct investment (FDI). Daniel Rosen, a long-time analyst of U.S.-China economic relationship, said that it is natural that foreign investment would decline sharply in the U.S. under extraordinary circumstances due to its open market economy, a feature that China lacks. Rosen said, "There is no reason to be concerned about the outlook for the FDI in the United States providing that the U.S. is sticking with its basic open-market competitive system." Previously, in 2003, China surpassed the US once as the biggest recipient of FDI.^[69]

Political scientist Matthew Kroenig states "according to an emerging conventional wisdom, China has the leg up on the U.S. in part because its authoritarian government can strategically plan for the long term, unencumbered by competing branches of government, regular elections, and public opinion. Yet this faith in autocratic ascendance and democratic decline is contrary to historical fact." Kroenig's makes the argument that open societies "facilitate innovation, trust in financial markets, and economic growth." Kroenig also suggests "the plans often cited as evidence of China's farsighted vision, the Belt and Road Initiative and Made in China 2025, were announced by Xi only in 2013 and 2015, respectively. Both are way too recent to be celebrated as brilliant examples of successful, long-term strategic planning."^[21]

According to David Leonhardt, "Beyond the economy, China has also made stark progress in other areas over the past decade. It is close to becoming the world's leading funder of scientific research and development, thanks to soaring increases in China and meager ones in the United States. The quality of American science remains higher, but the gap has narrowed."^[40] However, according to Barry Naughton, even at the purchasing power parity conversion rate, the average urban income was just over US\$10,000, and the average rural income was just under US\$4,000 in China. Naughton questioned whether it is economically sensible for a middle income country of this kind to be taking "such a disproportionate part of the risky expenditure involved in pioneering new technologies".^[70]

According to former Australian prime minister Kevin Rudd, "China has multiple domestic vulnerabilities that are rarely noted in the media. The United States, on the other hand, always has its weaknesses on full public display, but has repeatedly demonstrated its capacity for reinvention and restoration."^[71] Ryan Hass, a senior fellow in foreign policy at the Brookings Institution, said that much of the narrative of China "inexorably rising and on the verge of overtaking a faltering United States" was promoted by China's state-affiliated media outlets. Hass went on to say, "Authoritarian systems excel at showcasing their strengths and concealing their weaknesses. But policymakers in Washington must be able to distinguish between the image Beijing presents and the realities it confronts."^[72]

According to American economist Scott Rozelle and researcher Natalie Hell, "China looks a lot more like 1980s Mexico or Turkey than 1980s Taiwan or South Korea. No country has ever made it to high-income status with high school attainment rates below 50 percent. With China's high school attainment rate of 30 percent, the country could be in grave trouble."^[73] At age 30, the number of years of schooling in China is 34.6 percent less than in the United States. At age 40, the gap widens to 38.9 percent. At age 50, it further widens to 47 percent. At age 60, it becomes 55.5 percent.^[74] Rozelle and Hell warn that China risks falling into the middle income trap due to the rural urban divide in education and structural unemployment.^[73]

Ryan Hass at the Brookings Institution said that China's working-age population is already shrinking, adding, "by 2050, China will go from having eight workers per retiree now to two workers per retiree. Moreover, it has already squeezed out most of the large productivity gains that come with a population becoming more educated and urban and adopting technologies to make manufacturing more efficient."^[72] Nicholas Eberstadt, an economist and demographic expert at the American Enterprise Institute, said that current demographic trends will overwhelm China's economy and geopolitics, making its rise much more uncertain. He said, "The age of heroic economic growth is over."^[75]

Foreign policy

In May 2020, in accordance with the John S. McCain National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2019, the Trump administration delivered a report, "U.S. Strategic Approach to the People's Republic of China" to members of the U.S. Congress. The report states a whole-of-government approach to China under the 2017 National Security Strategy, which says it is time the U.S. "rethink the failed policies of the past two decades – policies based on the assumption that engagement with rivals and their inclusion in international institutions and global commerce would turn them into benign actors and trustworthy partners".^{[76][77]} The report says it "reflects a fundamental reevaluation of how the United States understands and responds to" the leaders of China, adding "The United States recognizes the long-term strategic competition between our two systems."^[78]

In February 2021, President Joe Biden said that China is the "most serious competitor" that poses challenges on the "prosperity, security, and democratic values" of the U.S.^[79] Secretary of State Antony Blinken stated that previous optimistic approaches to China were flawed, and that China poses "the most significant challenge of any nation-state in the world to the United States". Blinken also agreed that Biden's predecessor, Donald Trump, "was right in taking a tougher approach to China".^[80] In April 2021, the U.S. Senate introduced major legislation in response to China's growing clout in international affairs. The bill, titled "Strategic Competition Act of 2021", reflects hardline attitude of both congressional Democrats and Republicans, and sets out to counter the Chinese government's diplomatic and strategic initiatives.^[81]

In May 2021, the Strategic Competition Act of 2021 was consolidated into a larger bill, the United States Innovation and Competition Act (USICA), authorizing US\$110 billion for basic and advanced technology research over a five year period.^[82] In June 2021, the USICA passed 68-32 in the Senate with bipartisan support.^[83]

Comparison with earlier states

Samuel P. Huntington noticed that predictions of American decline have been part of American politics since the late 1950s. According to Daniel Bell, "many of America's leading commentators have had a powerful impulse consistently to see the United States as a weak, 'bred out' basket case that will fall to stronger rivals as inevitably as Rome fell to the barbarians, or France to Henry V at Agincourt."^{[4][13]} Huntington critiqued declinism as misguided, but praised it on some counts, "declinism has predicted the imminent shrinkage of American power. In all its phases that prediction has become central to preventing that shrinkage".^[84]

Michael Hudson points to debt forgiveness being necessary when individuals' debts to the state are too large. Whereas earlier empires (Assyrian) survived through periodic debt forgiveness, this practice ended with the Roman empire, resulting in impoverishment and dispossession of farmers, creating a growing lumpenproletariat. The same process contributed to the collapse of the British empire and continues today, with periodic financial crises (1930s, 2008) which are only relieved by government bailouts and/or war. Hudson adds that every time history repeats itself, the price goes up, i.e., the U.S. is being destroyed by bank debt with no forgiveness mechanism, making collapse inevitable.^[85]

Political scientist Paul K. Macdonald writes that great powers can be in relative or absolute decline and discussed the ways they often respond. The most common is retrenchment (reducing some but not all commitments of the state).^[86]

Roman empire

Certain commentators, historians and politicians believe U.S. is heir to the Roman empire. According to Kristofer Allerfeldt, there are divergent views regarding the Rome vs U.S. comparison. He believes that the "use of the Roman metaphor provides a scholarly patina to the expression of visceral hopes and fears."^[87]

Britain

Kennedy argues that "British financial strength was the single most decisive factor in its victories over France during the 18th century. This chapter ends on the Napoleonic Wars and the fusion of British financial strength with a newfound industrial strength." He predicts that, as the U.S. dollar loses its role as world currency, it will not be able to continue financing its military expenditures via deficit spending.^[25]

According to Richard Lachmann, the U.S. would last much longer if, like Britain, it could restrict particular families and elites from exclusively controlling offices and governmental powers.^[50]

Soviet Union

Historian Harold James wrote an article titled "Late Soviet America", comparing the present-day United States to the former Soviet Union. James wrote that many aspects of the US now resemble the late Soviet Union: intensification of social conflict, ethnic/racial rivalries, and economic decline. He predicted that the dollar may lose its value and start looking like the Soviet ruble. James ended the article saying that the economic decline will continue, even if there is change in leadership, pointing to Gorbachev's inability to prevent collapse after succeeding Brezhnev.^[88]

Alex Lo, a columnist from *South China Morning Post*, wrote, "Soviet Russia under Mikhail Gorbachev didn't know they had already lost the empire until it was too late. The fate of the United States will not be any different."^[89]

Commentators

- Philosophers Michael Hardt and Antonio Negri, theorize in the mid-1990s about an ongoing transition to an emergent construct created among ruling powers which the authors call "Empire".
- American historian Morris Berman wrote a trilogy of books published between 2000 and 2011 about the decline of American civilization.
- Igor Panarin, a political scientist and graduate of the Higher Military Command School of Telecommunications of the KGB, predicted that, starting in 1998, the US would collapse into six parts in 2010.^[90] He also wrote *The Crash of the Dollar and the Disintegration of the USA* (2009).^[91]
- Russian political analyst Stanislav Belkovsky predicted that it might be America's turn to plunge into self-destructive violence and inevitable collapse.^[92]
- American journalist Chris Hedges, in his 2018 book *America The Farewell Tour*, predicts that "within a decade, two at most" America will cease to be the dominant super-power in the world.^{[93][94]}
- In 2017, Evan Osnos of *The New Yorker* outlined a potential scenario for a violent revolution in the US and the consequences for the "super-rich."^[95]
- Donald Trump was the first presidential candidate to promote the idea that the United States was in decline.^[96]
- After the January 6 United States Capitol riots, *HuffPost* reporter Emily Peck wrote an article titled "The Capitol Riot Crystalizes 4 Years Of American Decline".^[97]

- Jean Chrétien, former prime minister of Canada (1993-2003), described Trump's election as a "monumental error" that heralded "the true end of the American empire" in a 2018 memoir.^[98]
- The American think tank Atlantic Council argues that while the US is indeed declining, thinking it is irreversible is "irrational pessimism".^[99]
- According to *The Intercept*, adoption of neutral path by Asian, African, and Latin American countries amid the Ukraine invasion could signal "a clean break from the past several centuries of Western hegemony, not just in politics but in culture and ideas as well."^[100]

Public opinion

2018 polls placed the U.S. leadership a notch below China's 31% and left Germany as the most popular power with an approval of 41%.^{[101][102]}

A 2019 survey carried out by Pew Research Center shows that a majority of Americans predicted the U.S. economy to be weaker in 2050. Also, the survey says, a majority of the people thought the U.S. would be "a country with a burgeoning national debt, a wider gap between the rich and the poor and a workforce threatened by automation."^[103]

In the midst of the COVID-19 pandemic, public opinion of both the United States and China worsened in most countries surveyed by Pew Research. The opinion of the US was more favorable than that of China overall; opinion of the handling of the pandemic was negative in both countries, but the opinion of China's handling of the pandemic was more favorable than the US.^[104]

According to a January 2021 survey of 1,032 people from ASEAN countries by Singapore's ISEAS–Yusof Ishak Institute, 61.5% of the respondents said they would choose the U.S. over China if they had to pick sides in the ongoing rivalry between the two countries. Support for the U.S. rose 7.9% from the previous year's survey.^[105]

In a 2021 poll of 1,019 Americans just after the riot at the Capitol, 79% of those surveyed said that America is "falling apart". At the same time, a similar proportion of survey respondents indicated that they are "proud to be an American".^{[14][15][16][17]}

In late January 2021, Pew reported that as Biden's inauguration approached, polls showed the international opinion of the United States in Europe improved significantly, raising to 72-84% optimism about US relations in Britain, France, and Germany.^[106]

A January 2022 poll conducted by NPR/Ipsos found that over 70% of U.S. respondents believe democracy is "in crisis and at risk of failing."^[107]

See also

- *After the Empire* by Emmanuel Todd
- American Century
- American Empire Project
- American imperialism
- Decadence
- *The Decline of the West* by Oswald Spengler
- Dumbing down
- *Idiocracy*, a 2006 science fiction comedy film

- Managed decline
- Pax Americana
- Political midlife crisis
- Political stagnation
- Rust Belt
- Sick man of Europe
- Societal collapse
- State collapse
- Superpower collapse
- Financial crisis of 2007–2008

References

1. Friedman, Hershey H.; Hertz, Sarah (2015). "Is the United States Still the Best Country in the World? Think Again". *SSRN Electronic Journal*. Elsevier BV. doi:10.2139/ssrn.2622722 (<https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.2622722>). ISSN 1556-5068 (<https://www.worldcat.org/issn/1556-5068>). S2CID 153146583 (<https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:153146583>).
2. "The Hidden Meaning Of American Decline" (https://www.huffingtonpost.com/entry/the-hidden-meaning-of-american-decline_us_5b057607e4b0ce1c4984ef5b). *Huffington Post*. May 24, 2018. Retrieved March 8, 2019.
3. ROSENBERG, MARK; MARBER, PETER (January 22, 2021). "Biden's opportunity to flip the script on U.S. decline" (<https://www.newsweek.com/bidens-opportunity-flip-script-us-decline-opinion-1563445>). *Newsweek*. Retrieved February 2, 2021.
4. McArdle, Megan (October 7, 2010). "America's Perpetual Decline" (<https://www.theatlantic.com/business/archive/2010/10/americas-perpetual-decline/64206/>). *The Atlantic*. Retrieved March 29, 2019.
5. Edelman, Eric S. (2010). "Understanding America's Contested Primacy" (<https://csbaonline.org/uploads/documents/2010.10.21-Understanding-Americas-Contested-Supremacy.pdf>) (PDF). Center for Strategic and Budgetary Assessments. Retrieved April 23, 2021.
6. Wyne, Ali (June 21, 2018). "Is America Choosing Decline?" (<https://newrepublic.com/article/149008/america-choosing-decline>). *The New Republic*. Retrieved March 28, 2019.
7. Brown, Stuart S. (2013). *The Future of US Global Power: Delusions of Decline* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=RgVBK3B1oOQC&q=US+cultural+decline>). Palgrave Macmillan. ISBN 9781137023155. Retrieved March 24, 2019.
8. Rapoza, Kenneth. "The Future: China's Rise, America's Decline" (<https://www.forbes.com/sites/kenrapoza/2017/03/26/the-future-chinas-rise-americas-decline/#43133b093b2f>). *Forbes*. Retrieved March 28, 2019.
9. Allison, Graham (October 15, 2020). "China Is Now the World's Largest Economy. We Shouldn't Be Shocked" (<https://nationalinterest.org/feature/china-now-world%E2%80%99s-largest-economy-we-shouldn%E2%80%99t-be-shocked-170719>). *The National Interest*. Retrieved October 23, 2020.
10. "Asia Power Index | US" (<https://power.lowyinstitute.org/countries/united-states/>). *power.lowyinstitute.org*. Retrieved October 20, 2020. "The United States remains the most powerful country in the region but registered the largest fall in relative power of any Indo-Pacific country in 2020. A ten-point overall lead over China two years ago has been narrowed by half in 2020."
11. "China - Lowy Institute Asia Power Index" (<https://power.lowyinstitute.org/>). *Lowy Institute Asia Power Index 2021*. Retrieved December 5, 2021.

12. Weisbrode, Kenneth (July 19, 2016). "Don't Panic about America's Cultural Decline" (<https://nationalinterest.org/feature/dont-panic-about-americas-cultural-decline-17024>). *The National Interest*. Retrieved March 26, 2019.
13. Bell, David A. (October 7, 2010). "Political Columnists Think America Is In Decline. Big Surprise" (<https://newrepublic.com/article/78216/america-in-decline-thomas-friedman>). *The New Republic*. ISSN 0028-6583 (<https://www.worldcat.org/issn/0028-6583>). Retrieved January 8, 2021.
14. Allen, Mike (January 14, 2021). "Republicans and Democrats agree — the country is falling apart" (<https://www.axios.com/poll-america-falling-apart-4a13376f-f962-46e3-8e2c-174d396f25d1.html>). *Axios*. Retrieved January 29, 2021.
15. "79 percent of Americans say US is falling apart" (<https://futurism.com/the-byte/america-falling-apart>). *Futurism*. Retrieved January 29, 2021.
16. "Majority of Americans now support removing Trump from office" (<https://www.ipsos.com/en-us/news-polls/unrest-capitol-election-certification-010621>). Ipsos. January 13, 2021. Retrieved February 2, 2021.
17. Castronuovo, Celine (January 14, 2021). "4 in 5 say US is falling apart: survey" (<https://thehill.com/homenews/news/534204-4-in-5-say-us-is-falling-apart-survey>). *The Hill*. Retrieved February 2, 2021.
18. Chomsky, Noam. "American Decline: Causes and Consequences" (<https://chomsky.info/20110824/>). *chomsky.info*. Retrieved March 8, 2019.
19. Jeet, Heer (March 7, 2018). "Are We Witnessing the Fall of the American Empire?" (<https://newrepublic.com/article/147319/witnessing-fall-american-empire>). *The New Republic*. Retrieved March 18, 2019.
20. FRIEDBERG, AARON L. (November 1, 2009). "Same Old Songs" (<https://www.the-american-interest.com/2009/11/01/same-old-songs/>). *The American Interest*. Retrieved April 23, 2021.
21. Kroenig, Matthew (April 3, 2020). "Why the U.S. Will Outcompete China" (<https://www.theatlantic.com/ideas/archive/2020/04/why-china-ill-equipped-great-power-rivalry/609364/>). *The Atlantic*. Retrieved February 6, 2021.
22. Schmitt, Eric (November 14, 2018). "U.S. Military's Global Edge Has Diminished, Strategy Review Finds" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2018/11/14/us/politics/defense-strategy-china-russia.html>). *The New York Times*. Retrieved March 19, 2019.
23. Farley, Robert (July 5, 2018). "Yes, the U.S. Military Is In Decline. And There Is No Need to Panic" (<https://nationalinterest.org/blog/buzz/yes-us-military-decline-and-there-no-need-panic-25057>). *National Interest*. Retrieved March 19, 2019.
24. Thompson, Loren (April 24, 2017). "Five Reasons Trump Won't Reverse The U.S. Military's Long Decline" (<https://www.forbes.com/sites/lorenthompson/2017/04/24/five-reasons-trump-wont-reverse-the-u-s-militarys-long-decline/#7b003fda280c>). *Forbes*. Retrieved March 19, 2019.
25. Kennedy, Paul (January 26, 2017). *The Rise And Fall of British Naval Mastery* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=6oQ1DQAAQBAJ&q=The+Rise+and+Fall+of+the+Great+Powers>). Penguin Books. ISBN 9780141983837. Retrieved March 19, 2019.
26. Kennedy, Paul M., *The Rise and Fall of the Great Powers: Economic Change and Military Conflict from 1500 to 2000*, New York, Vintage Books, 1987, ISBN 0679-720197, p. 534.
27. Catley, Bob, "Hegemonic America: The Benign Superpower?" *Contemporary Southeast Asia*, Vol. 18, No. 4 (March 1997), p. 382|<https://www.jstor.org/stable/25798354>
28. "The good European" (<https://www.newstatesman.com/node/159124>). *www.newstatesman.com*. Retrieved January 27, 2021.

29. Johnson, Chalmers (February 6, 2007). *Nemesis: The Last Days of the American Republic* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=vtkAtY8xwHIC&q=The+Last+Days+of+the+American+Republic>). Henry Holt and Company. ISBN 9781429904681. Retrieved March 19, 2019.
30. Goldfarb, Jeffrey C. (1989). "The Decline and Fall of American Culture?". *Social Research*. **56** (3): 659–680. JSTOR 40970560 (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/40970560>).
31. Bennett, William J. "Quantifying America's Decline" (<https://ashbrook.org/publications/onprin-v1n1-bennett/>). *Ashbrook*. Retrieved March 24, 2019.
32. "RealClearPolitics - Articles - Three Centuries of American Declinism" (<https://www.realclearpolitics.com/articles/2007/08/declinism.html>). *www.realclearpolitics.com*. Retrieved July 24, 2021.
33. "American Declinism: has collective fear finally become reality?" (<https://www.abc.net.au/radionational/programs/futuretense/american-declinism/5865146>). *ABC Radio National*. November 4, 2014. Retrieved July 24, 2021.
34. McArdle, Megan (October 7, 2010). "America's Perpetual Decline" (<https://www.theatlantic.com/business/archive/2010/10/americas-perpetual-decline/64206/>). *The Atlantic*. Retrieved March 29, 2019.
35. "Robert Lieber on Why the Declinists Are Wrong About America" (<https://cirs.qatar.georgetown.edu/event/robert-lieber-why-declinists-are-wrong-about-america/>). *CIRS*. Retrieved July 24, 2021.
36. Joffe, Josef (December 9, 2011). "Declinism's Fifth Wave" (<https://www.the-american-interest.com/2011/12/09/declinisms-fifth-wave/>). *The American Interest*. Retrieved July 24, 2021.
37. "Political Polarization in the American Public" (<https://www.pewresearch.org/politics/2014/06/12/political-polarization-in-the-american-public/>). *Pew Research Center - U.S. Politics & Policy*. June 12, 2014. Retrieved February 6, 2021.
38. Dunsmuir, Lindsay (October 11, 2017). "IMF calls for fiscal policies that tackle rising inequality" (<https://www.reuters.com/article/imf-g20-inequality/imf-calls-for-fiscal-policies-that-tackle-rising-inequality-idUSL2N1ML16B>). *Reuters*. Retrieved April 17, 2021.
39. Stewart, Alexander J.; McCarty, Nolan; Bryson, Joanna J. (2020). "Polarization under rising inequality and economic decline" (<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC7732181>). *Science Advances*. **6** (50): eabd4201. arXiv:1807.11477 (<https://arxiv.org/abs/1807.11477>). Bibcode:2020SciA....6.4201S (<https://ui.adsabs.harvard.edu/abs/2020SciA....6.4201S>). doi:10.1126/sciadv.abd4201 (<https://doi.org/10.1126%2Fsciadv.abd4201>). PMC 7732181 (<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC7732181>). PMID 33310855 (<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33310855>). S2CID 216144890 (<https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:216144890>).
40. Leonhardt, David (January 16, 2020). "Opinion | What Americans Don't Understand About China's Power (Published 2020)" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2020/01/16/opinion/sunday/china-economy-trade.html>). *The New York Times*. ISSN 0362-4331 (<https://www.worldcat.org/issn/0362-4331>). Retrieved February 6, 2021.
41. Howard, Philip; Ganesh, Bharath; Liotsiou, Dimitra; Kelly, John; François, Camille (October 1, 2019). "The IRA, Social Media and Political Polarization in the United States, 2012-2018" (<https://digitalcommons.unl.edu/senatedocs/1>). *U.S. Senate Documents*.
42. "Report: Russia still using social media to roil US politics" (<https://apnews.com/article/8890210ce2ce4256a7df6e4ab65c33d3>). *AP NEWS*. December 18, 2018. Retrieved March 28, 2021.
43. Kreps, Sarah (September 22, 2020). "The shifting chessboard of international influence operations" (<https://www.brookings.edu/techstream/the-shifting-chessboard-of-international-influence-operations/>). *Brookings*. Retrieved March 28, 2021.

44. "Opinion | The good, the bad and the (very) ugly foreign policy legacy Trump leaves for Biden" (<https://www.nbcnews.com/think/opinion/trump-s-america-first-policies-leave-biden-major-china-russia-ncna1251044>). *NBC News*. Retrieved March 28, 2021.
45. "Feelings of Political Violence Rise" (<https://www.statista.com/chart/23124/political-violence/>). *statista*. Retrieved March 31, 2021.
46. Hall, Madison; Metzger, Bryan. "Majority of Trump voters believe it's 'time to split the country' in two, new poll finds" (<https://www.businessinsider.com/majority-of-trump-voters-believe-its-time-to-secede-survey-finds-2021-10?IR=T>). *Business Insider*. Retrieved October 3, 2021.
47. "World Economic Outlook Database, October 2020" (<https://www.imf.org/en/Publications/WEO/weo-database/2020/October/weo-report?c=512,914,612,614,311,213,911,314,193,122,912,313,419,513,316,913,124,339,638,514,218,963,616,223,516,918,748,618,624,522,622,156,626,628,228,924,233,632,636,634,238,662,960,423,935,128,611,321,243,248,469,253,642,643,939,734,644,819,172,132,646,648,915,134,652,174,328,258,656,654,336,263,268,532,944,176,534,536,429,433,178,436,136,343,158,439,916,664,826,542,967,443,917,544,941,446,666,668,672,946,137,546,674,676,548,556,678,181,867,682,684,273,868,921,948,943,686,688,518,728,836,558,138,196,278,692,694,962,142,449,564,565,283,853,288,293,566,964,182,359,453,968,922,714,862,135,716,456,722,942,718,724,576,936,961,813,726,199,733,184,524,361,362,364,732,366,144,146,463,528,923,738,578,537,742,866,369,744,186,925,869,746,926,466,112,111,298,927,846,299,582,487,474,754,698,&s=NGDPD,&sy=2018&ey=2025&ssm=0&scsm=1&ssc=0&ssd=1&ssc=0&sic=0&sort=country&ds=.&br=1>). *IMF.org*. International Monetary Fund. October 13, 2020. Retrieved October 13, 2020.
48. Coplan, Jill Hamburg. "12 signs America is on the decline" (<http://fortune.com/2015/07/20/united-states-decline-statistics-economic/>). *Fortune*. Retrieved March 28, 2019.
49. Telford, Taylor (September 26, 2019). "Income inequality in America is the highest it's been since census started tracking it, data shows" (<https://www.washingtonpost.com/business/2019/09/26/income-inequality-america-highest-its-been-since-census-started-tracking-it-data-show/>). *The Washington Post*. Retrieved April 17, 2021.
50. Lachmann, Richard (2011). "The roots of american decline". *Contexts*. **10** (1): 44–49. doi:10.1177/1536504211399050 (<https://doi.org/10.1177%2F1536504211399050>). ISSN 1536-5042 (<https://www.worldcat.org/issn/1536-5042>). JSTOR 41960690 (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/41960690>). S2CID 61355963 (<https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:61355963>).
51. Muennig, Peter A.; Reynolds, Megan; Fink, David S.; Zafari, Zafar; Geronimus, Arline T. (2018). "America's Declining Well-Being, Health, and Life Expectancy: Not Just a White Problem" (<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC6221922>). *American Journal of Public Health*. **108** (12): 1626–1631. doi:10.2105/AJPH.2018.304585 (<https://doi.org/10.2105%2FAJPH.2018.304585>). ISSN 0090-0036 (<https://www.worldcat.org/issn/0090-0036>). PMC 6221922 (<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC6221922>). PMID 30252522 (<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/30252522>).
52. "Pregnancy Mortality Surveillance System | Maternal and Infant Health | CDC" (<https://www.cdc.gov/reproductivehealth/maternal-mortality/pregnancy-mortality-surveillance-system.htm>). *www.cdc.gov*. February 4, 2020.
53. Case A, Deaton A (2020). *Deaths of Despair and the Future of Capitalism* (<https://press.princeton.edu/books/hardcover/9780691190785/deaths-of-despair-and-the-future-of-capitalism>). Princeton University Press. ISBN 978-0691190785.
54. Haynie, Devon (2020). "Report: American Quality of Life Declines Over Past Decade" (<https://www.usnews.com/news/best-countries/articles/2020-09-11/a-global-anomaly-the-us-declines-in-annual-quality-of-life-report>). *usnews*.

55. Tollefson, Jeff (October 5, 2020). "How Trump damaged science — and why it could take decades to recover" (<https://doi.org/10.1038%2Fd41586-020-02800-9>). *Nature*. **586** (7828): 190–194. Bibcode:2020Natur.586..190T (<https://ui.adsabs.harvard.edu/abs/2020Natur.586..190T>). doi:10.1038/d41586-020-02800-9 (<https://doi.org/10.1038%2Fd41586-020-02800-9>). PMID 33020603 (<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33020603>).
56. Maxmen, Amy; Tollefson, Jeff (August 4, 2020). "Two decades of pandemic war games failed to account for Donald Trump" (<https://doi.org/10.1038%2Fd41586-020-02277-6>). *Nature*. **584** (7819): 26–29. Bibcode:2020Natur.584...26M (<https://ui.adsabs.harvard.edu/abs/2020Natur.584...26M>). doi:10.1038/d41586-020-02277-6 (<https://doi.org/10.1038%2Fd41586-020-02277-6>). PMID 32753759 (<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/32753759>).
57. Paz, Christian (November 2, 2020). "All the President's Lies About the Coronavirus" (<https://www.theatlantic.com/politics/archive/2020/11/trumps-lies-about-coronavirus/608647/>). *The Atlantic*. Retrieved February 5, 2021.
58. "Global perception of US falls to two-decade low" (<https://www.bbc.com/news/world-us-canada-54169732>). *BBC News*. September 15, 2020. Retrieved February 5, 2021.
59. "U.S. Image Plummets Internationally as Most Say Country Has Handled Coronavirus Badly" (<https://www.pewresearch.org/global/2020/09/15/us-image-plummets-internationally-as-most-say-country-has-handled-coronavirus-badly/>). *Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Project*. September 15, 2020. Retrieved February 5, 2021.
60. "US being left behind after Asia forms world's biggest trade bloc RCEP: US Chamber" (<https://www.channelnewsasia.com/news/asia/rcep-us-chamber-of-commerce-left-behind-asia-economy-trade-13576598>). *CNA*. Retrieved January 29, 2021.
61. "Why the U.S. Could Be the Big Loser in the Huge RCEP Trade Deal Between China and 14 Other Countries" (<https://time.com/5912325/rcep-china-trade-deal-us/>). *Time*. Retrieved January 29, 2021.
62. Bird, Mike (November 5, 2019). "Asia's Huge Trade Pact Is a Paper Tiger in the Making" (<https://www.wsj.com/articles/asias-huge-trade-pact-is-a-paper-tiger-in-the-making-11572943887>). *The Wall Street Journal*. Retrieved February 1, 2021.
63. Mahadevan, Renuka; Nugroho, Anda (September 10, 2019). "Can the Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership minimise the harm from the United States–China trade war?". *The World Economy*. Wiley. **42** (11): 3148–3167. doi:10.1111/twec.12851 (<https://doi.org/10.1111%2Ftwec.12851>). ISSN 0378-5920 (<https://www.worldcat.org/issn/0378-5920>). S2CID 202308592 (<https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:202308592>).
64. EST, Tom O'Connor On 12/4/20 at 2:41 PM (December 4, 2020). "China celebrates surpassing US in trade with EU for the first time" (<https://www.newsweek.com/china-good-news-passes-us-trade-europe-1552454>). *Newsweek*. Retrieved December 7, 2020.
65. "The Strategic Implications of the China-EU Investment Deal" (<https://thediplomat.com/2021/01/the-strategic-implications-of-the-china-eu-investment-deal/>). *thediplomat.com*. Retrieved January 11, 2021.
66. "Will the Sudden E.U.-China Deal Damage Relations With Biden?" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2021/01/06/world/europe/eu-china-deal-biden.html>). *The New York Times*.
67. Lau, Stuart (March 22, 2021). "China throws EU trade deal to the wolf warriors" (<https://www.politico.eu/article/china-throws-eu-trade-deal-to-the-wolf-warriors-sanctions-investment-pact/>). *Politico*. Retrieved March 23, 2021.
68. Blenkinsop, Philip (March 23, 2021). "EU-China deal grinds into reverse after tit-for-tat sanctions" (<https://www.reuters.com/article/us-eu-china-trade-idUSKBN2BF276>). *Reuters*. Retrieved March 23, 2021.

69. Jeong, Paul Hannon and Eun-young (January 24, 2021). "China Overtakes U.S. as World's Leading Destination for Foreign Direct Investment" (<https://www.wsj.com/articles/china-overtakes-u-s-as-worlds-leading-destination-for-foreign-direct-investment-11611511200>). *Wall Street Journal*. ISSN 0099-9660 (<https://www.worldcat.org/issn/0099-9660>). Retrieved January 24, 2021.
70. Barry Naughton. "The Rise of China's Industrial Policy, 1978 to 2020" (https://www.riennner.com/title/The_Rise_of_China_s_Industrial_Policy_1978_to_2020). Lynne Rienner Publishers. Retrieved March 18, 2021.
71. Rudd, Kevin (February 5, 2021). "Short of War" (<https://www.foreignaffairs.com/articles/united-states/2021-02-05/kevin-rudd-usa-chinese-confrontation-short-of-war>). *Foreign Affairs*. Retrieved February 8, 2021.
72. Hass, Ryan (March 3, 2021). "China Is Not Ten Feet Tall" (<https://www.foreignaffairs.com/articles/china/2021-03-03/china-not-ten-feet-tall>). *Foreign Affairs*. Retrieved March 4, 2021.
73. Hell, Natalie, and Rozelle, Scott. *Invisible China: How the Urban-Rural Divide Threatens China's Rise*. University of Chicago Press, 2020.
74. Cai, Fang (2012). "The Coming Demographic Impact on China's Growth: The Age Factor in the Middle-Income Trap". *Asian Economic Papers*. MIT Press - Journals. **11** (1): 95–111. doi:10.1162/asep_a_00121 (https://doi.org/10.1162%2Fasep_a_00121). ISSN 1535-3516 (<https://www.worldcat.org/issn/1535-3516>). S2CID 57566620 (<https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:57566620>).
75. LeVine, Steve (July 3, 2019). "Demographics may decide the U.S-China rivalry" (<https://www.axios.com/demographics-decide-us-china-rivalry-64ef68fb-b34e-4216-870b-0a6cf0d8b946.html>). *Axios*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200720171818/https://www.axios.com/demographics-decide-us-china-rivalry-64ef68fb-b34e-4216-870b-0a6cf0d8b946.html>) from the original on July 20, 2020. Retrieved February 16, 2021.
76. "United States Strategic Approach to The People" (<https://www.defense.gov/Newsroom/Releases/Release/Article/2193725/united-states-strategic-approach-to-the-peoples-republic-of-china/>). U.S. Department of Defense. May 20, 2020. Retrieved February 5, 2021.
77. "United States Strategic Approach to the People's Republic of China" (<https://trumpwhitehouse.archives.gov/articles/united-states-strategic-approach-to-the-peoples-republic-of-china/>). The White House. May 26, 2020. Retrieved February 5, 2021.
78. "United States Strategic Approach to the People's Republic of China" (<https://trumpwhitehouse.archives.gov/wp-content/uploads/2020/05/U.S.-Strategic-Approach-to-The-Peoples-Republic-of-China-Report-5.24v1.pdf>) (PDF). The White House. May 20, 2020. Retrieved February 5, 2021.
79. "Remarks by President Biden on America's Place in the World" (<https://www.whitehouse.gov/briefing-room/speeches-remarks/2021/02/04/remarks-by-president-biden-on-americas-place-in-the-world/>). The White House. February 4, 2021. Retrieved February 6, 2021.
80. Mauldin, William; Gordon, Michael R. (January 20, 2021). "Blinken Backs Tough Approach to China, Says Will Work With GOP" (https://www.wsj.com/articles/blinken-to-address-u-s-rivalry-with-china-russia-in-senate-hearing-11611069439?mod=article_inline). *The Wall Street Journal*. Retrieved January 28, 2021.
81. Zengerle, Patricia; Brunnstrom, David (April 8, 2021). "Details of sweeping effort to counter China emerge in U.S. Senate" (<https://www.reuters.com/article/us-usa-china-senate/details-of-sweeping-effort-to-counter-china-emerge-in-u-s-senate-idUSKBN2BV1UE>). *Reuters*. Retrieved April 13, 2021.

82. Rattigan, Kathryn M. (April 15, 2021). "The Endless Frontier Act: Shifting the Focus from Defense to Offense" (<https://www.natlawreview.com/article/endless-frontier-act-shifting-focus-defense-to-offense>). *National Law Review*, Volume XI, Number 105. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210513090302/https://www.natlawreview.com/article/endless-frontier-act-shifting-focus-defense-to-offense>) from the original on May 13, 2021. Retrieved May 13, 2021.
83. Basu, Zachary (June 8, 2021). "Senate passes sweeping China competition bill in rare bipartisan vote" (<https://www.axios.com/senate-china-competition-bipartisan-e2fa3f88-16d4-4d79-bab0-1b9c6a4f2774.html>). *Axios*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210608230357/https://www.axios.com/senate-china-competition-bipartisan-e2fa3f88-16d4-4d79-bab0-1b9c6a4f2774.html>) from the original on June 8, 2021. Retrieved June 8, 2021.
84. Wyne, Ali (July 25, 2019). "Yes, Sam Huntington Has Insights to Guide U.S. Competition with China" (<https://www.rand.org/blog/2019/07/yes-sam-huntington-has-insights-to-guide-u-s-competition.html>). *www.rand.org*. Retrieved January 8, 2021.
85. Hudson, Michael (2015). *Killing the Host: How Financial Parasites and Debt Destroy the Global Economy* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=ZhkZjgEACAAJ&q=Killing+the+Host:+How+financial+parasites+and+debt+destroy+the+global+economy>). ISLET-Verlag. ISBN 9783981484281. Retrieved March 17, 2019.
86. MacDonald, Paul K.; Parent, Joseph M. (2018). *Twilight of the Titans: Great Power Decline and Retrenchment* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=aDFEDwAAQBAJ&q=Twilight+of+the+Titans:+Great+Power+Decline+and+Retrenchment>). Cornell University Press. ISBN 9781501717109. Retrieved March 8, 2019.
87. Allerfeldt, Kristofer (2008). "Rome, Race, and the Republic: Progressive America and the Fall of the Roman Empire, 1890-1920" (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/25144530>). *The Journal of the Gilded Age and Progressive Era*. 7 (3): 297–323. doi:10.1017/S1537781400000736 (<https://doi.org/10.1017/S1537781400000736>). ISSN 1537-7814 (<https://www.worldcat.org/issn/1537-7814>). JSTOR 25144530 (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/25144530>). S2CID 163132995 (<https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:163132995>). Retrieved January 25, 2022.
88. James, Harold (July 1, 2020). "Late Soviet America" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210620185403/https://www.project-syndicate.org/commentary/american-decline-under-trump-lessons-from-soviet-union-by-harold-james-2020-07>). *Project Syndicate*. Archived from the original (<https://www.project-syndicate.org/commentary/american-decline-under-trump-lessons-from-soviet-union-by-harold-james-2020-07>) on June 20, 2021.
89. "Forget the rise of China, it's the fall of America you should worry about" (<https://www.scmp.com/comment/opinion/article/3116850/forget-rise-china-its-fall-america-you-should-worry-about>). *South China Morning Post*. January 7, 2021. Retrieved February 1, 2021.
90. Osborn, Andrew (December 29, 2008). "As if Things Weren't Bad Enough, Russian Professor Predicts End of U.S." (<https://www.wsj.com/articles/SB123051100709638419>). *Wall Street Journal*. ISSN 0099-9660 (<https://www.worldcat.org/issn/0099-9660>). Retrieved February 7, 2021.
91. Bohm, Michael (November 29, 2012). "Russia's Misery Loves U.S. Company" (<https://www.themoscowtimes.com/2012/11/29/russias-misery-loves-us-company-a19777>). *The Moscow Times*. Retrieved November 30, 2020.
92. Shlapentokh, Dmitry (July 29, 2020). "How the Putin Regime Perceives US Protests" (<https://imrussia.org/en/analysis/3144-how-the-putin-regime-perceives-us-protests>).
93. Hedges, Chris (2018). *America: The Farewell Tour*. Simon & Schuster. ISBN 978-1501152672.
94. Chris Hedges - The American Empire Will Collapse Within a Decade, Two at Most (11-19-18) (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tCDd3VoAFUs>) on YouTube

95. "Doomsday Prep for the Super-Rich: Some of the wealthiest people in America—in Silicon Valley, New York, and beyond—are getting ready for the crackup of civilization" (<https://www.newyorker.com/magazine/2017/01/30/doomsday-prep-for-the-super-rich>). *New Yorker*. January 30, 2017.
96. Engelhardt, Tom (September 27, 2018). "America Was in Decline Long Before Trump Stepped Into Office" (<https://www.thenation.com/article/america-was-in-decline-long-before-trump-stepped-into-office/>). *The Nation*. Retrieved March 17, 2019.
97. Peck, Emily (January 8, 2021). "The Capitol Riot Crystalizes 4 Years Of American Decline" (https://www.huffpost.com/entry/america-business-economy-trump-riot-biden_n_5ff77d26c5b612d958ea6675). *HuffPost*. Retrieved January 25, 2021.
98. Campion-Smith, Bruce (October 9, 2018). "Jean Chrétien calls Donald Trump 'fanatical'" (<https://www.thestar.com/news/canada/2018/10/09/jean-chretien-calls-donald-trump-fanatical.html>). *Toronto Star*. Retrieved July 15, 2021.
99. "The Longer Telegram: Toward a new American China strategy" (<https://www.atlanticcouncil.org/content-series/atlantic-council-strategy-paper-series/the-longer-telegram/>). *Atlantic Council*. January 28, 2021. Retrieved January 29, 2021.
100. Hussain, Murtaza (March 26, 2022). "Not One Bloc or the Other: Ukraine War Shows Emerging Post-American World" (<https://theintercept.com/2022/03/26/ukraine-russia-india-africa-stance/>). *The Intercept*. Retrieved April 1, 2022.
101. Clifton, Jon. "Rating World Leaders: 2018 The U.S. vs. Germany, China and Russia" (<https://www.politico.com/f/?id=00000161-0647-da3c-a371-867f6acc0001>). *Politico*. Retrieved March 17, 2019.
102. Ray, Julie (January 18, 2018). "World's Approval of U.S. Leadership Drops to New Low" (<https://news.gallup.com/poll/225761/world-approval-leadership-drops-new-low.aspx>). *Gallup.com*. Retrieved March 17, 2019.
103. "Public Sees America's Future in Decline on Many Fronts | Pew Research Center" (<https://www.pewsocialtrends.org/2019/03/21/public-sees-an-america-in-decline-on-many-fronts/>). March 21, 2019. Retrieved March 28, 2019.
104. "Negative views of both U.S. and China abound across advanced economies amid COVID-19" (<https://www.pewresearch.org/fact-tank/2020/10/06/negative-views-of-both-us-and-china-amid-covid-19/>). *Pew Research Center*. Retrieved February 5, 2021.
105. Tani, Shotaro (February 10, 2021). "On China: more awe than affection" (<https://s.nikkei.com/3q65NVA>). *The Nikkei*. Retrieved February 10, 2021.
106. "British, French and Germans Give Biden High Marks After U.S. Election" (<https://www.pewresearch.org/global/2021/01/19/british-french-and-german-publics-give-biden-high-marks-after-u-s-election/>). *Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Project*. January 19, 2021. Retrieved February 5, 2021.
107. Rose, Joel; Baker, Liz (January 3, 2022). "6 in 10 Americans say U.S. democracy is in crisis as 'The Big Lie' takes root" (<https://www.npr.org/2022/01/03/1069764164/american-democracy-poll-jan-6>). *NPR*. Retrieved January 3, 2022. "Overall, 70% of poll respondents agree that the country is in crisis and at risk of failing."

Further reading

- Andrews, Charles (2015). *The Hollow Colossus* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=NIERrgEACAAJ&q=hollow+colossus+andrews>). Needle Press. p. 210. ISBN 9780967990545. Retrieved April 3, 2019.
-

This page was last edited on 15 April 2022, at 00:27 (UTC).

Text is available under the Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike License 3.0; additional terms may apply. By using this site, you agree to the Terms of Use and Privacy Policy. Wikipedia® is a registered trademark of the Wikimedia Foundation, Inc., a non-profit organization.